

**FUTURE BUSINESS ANALYST SEASON 6
ROUND 2 BUSINESS ANALYTICS REPORT**

DNSE Securities Joint Stock Company

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Executive summary

DNSE Securities leads Vietnam's brokers in account growth. Zero-fee trading on the Entrade X app, together with Margin Deal, Future X and the Ensa assistant, brought it one in five of the country's new securities accounts in 2025 and more than 1.7 million accounts by mid-2026, 12.3 per cent of the market. Customer money has not followed. DNSE holds 2.3 per cent of the cash investors keep at brokers, 1.4 per cent of margin lending and 0.6 per cent of industry profit. In December 2025, 5.7 per cent of its accounts used at least one product and 1.8 per cent held net assets of VND 10 million or more.

The funding gap is costly. Brokerage revenue has been below its direct cost for 16 consecutive quarters, and annualised return on equity fell to 3.8 per cent in the first half of 2026. Without a parent bank, DNSE borrows short term against pledged deposits that tie up 38 per cent of its assets. Between 2021 and 2025, accounts grew 33.8 times while core pre-tax profit grew 2.7 times. Platform and overhead costs of about VND 198 billion in 2025 fall on few funded customers, about VND 7.3 million a year for each account with VND 10 million or more, and at the industry's average cash per account DNSE would hold 5.4 times its current investor cash.

Three causes explain the gap, with different strengths of evidence. DNSE's tools attract young traders with little capital. Trust fails at the first deposit, since complaints about deception, sign-up bonus terms and a closure fee appear in 37 per cent of DNSE's negative reviews since 2025, against 8 per cent at VPS, and the rating of substantive reviews fell from 4.15 in 2024 to 2.38 in 2025. Most important, no DNSE product turns a salaried customer's intention to invest into regular deposits, although 22.1 million Vietnamese adults hold an account without saving formally.

The core problem is the funding gap among existing accounts, and trust is a condition of any solution. We recommend Payday Portfolio, a goal-based investing plan built from products DNSE already runs. Ensa proposes one of three model portfolios inside DNSE's licensed advisory service, and the customer confirms it. A standing order then moves part of each salary into a virtual account in the customer's own name, and each contribution is invested in the asset class furthest below its target weight. Free commitment tiers reward three, six and twelve consecutive contributions, with one skipped month a year allowed, and trust controls remove the closure fee and conditional sign-up rewards. DNSE's wider technology should be organised around customer balances. ZaloPay round-ups become an entry route for customers without a salary, rule-based strategies become additional model portfolios, and a dashboard shows where client cash is held. A credit line secured on savings is not recommended because it conflicts with lending rules.

In the base case, 150,000 savers contributing VND 1.5 million a month would hold VND 2.8 trillion after 18 months, 1.4 times DNSE's current investor cash, and tier interest would cost at most VND 5.6 billion a year. Customer segments and intent remain hypotheses because DNSE does not publish customer-level data. Appendix F sets out a randomised pilot with 20,000 dormant customers. Its headline KPI is the number of accounts holding VND 10 million or more, 27,100 at the end of 2025, with a target of 85,000 within 18 months.

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1. Introduction

1.1 DNSE and its business model

DNSE Securities began in 2007 as Dai Nam Securities. Rebuilt by the Encapital group as a branchless, technology-led broker, it listed on HOSE in July 2024 (CafeF, 2024). Its Entrade X app offers free share trading for life, derivatives, deal-by-deal margin loans (Margin Deal) and an artificial intelligence assistant (Ensa). Two products hold customer money. The Never-Sleeping Account, an idle-cash account launched in June 2025, pays 1.8 to 4.3 per cent a year, and Golden Egg sells bonds from VND 1 million (DNSE Securities, 2026b, 2026c). In the first half of 2026, margin interest supplied 40 per cent of operating revenue and brokerage 26 per cent (Table B1).

1.2 Vietnam context and the market gap

Three conditions shape how DNSE's data should be read. First, banks pay savers more, and 12-month deposit rates at state banks reached about 6.8 per cent in 2026 (VnEconomy, 2026; VietnamNet, 2026). A typical DNSE customer earns 2.1 to 2.3 per cent on idle cash, below inflation of 4.45 per cent (Figure 1).

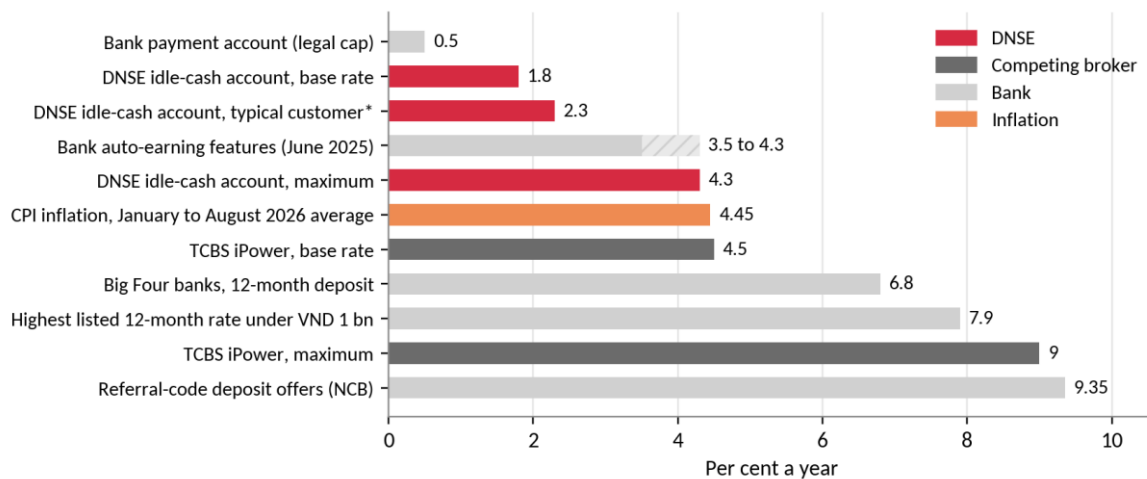


Figure 1. Returns on a saver's idle cash, September 2026

Source: DNSE Securities (2025, 2026b); TCBS (2026); VietnamNet (2026); VnExpress (2026b); Bao Dau Thau (2026).

Second, investor cash at brokers fell 38 per cent in three quarters (VnEconomy, 2026). DNSE's cash fell in the same proportion (Figure 2), so its recent decline is cyclical, while its small share of cash is structural. Third, bank-owned brokers supplied 62 per cent of lending growth in the second quarter of 2026 (Vietstock, 2026c), so DNSE cannot compete on the price of credit. Banks must also open their application interfaces to third parties by March 2027 (State Bank of Vietnam, 2024).

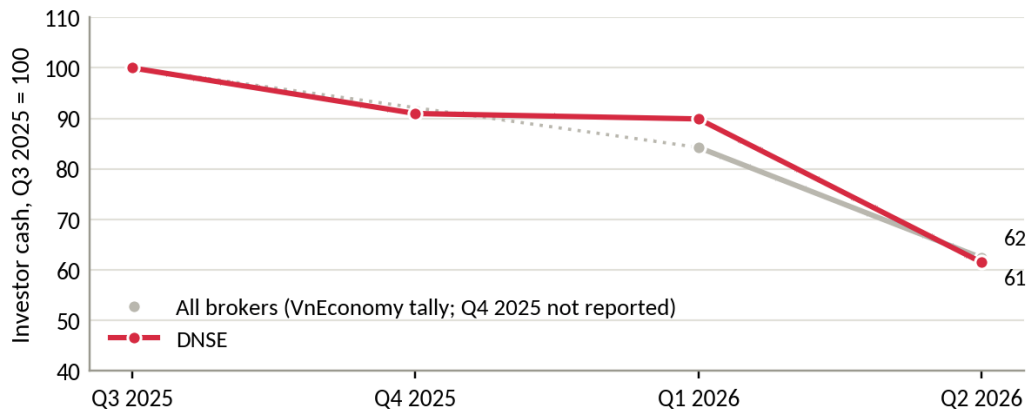


Figure 2. Investor cash held at brokers, third quarter of 2025 = 100

Source: VnEconomy (2026); DNSE filings. Industry total for Q4 2025 not reported.

The market gap lies between banks, which hold salaries but offer little investment, and brokers, whose products start after a customer decides to invest (Table C3).

1.3 Business question and scope

Business question. Why do DNSE's accounts not become funded relationships, and which initiative would convert them most cost-effectively within DNSE's capabilities and licences? The scope covers retail customers from account opening to regular funding.

2. Findings of observations

2.1 Evidence base and method

The evidence combines DNSE's filed statements from 2018 to mid-2026, reconciled to the reviewed half-year statements, its 2025 annual report, peer and industry data, 3,299 app reviews of DNSE, VPS and FPTs, and Global Findex 2024 data (Table A1). Spam, 23 per cent of DNSE's Google Play reviews, was removed with tested rules (Appendix A). DNSE publishes no customer-level data, so statements about segments and intent are labelled as hypotheses.

2.2 Finding 1. Accounts are opened but rarely funded

DNSE opened 518,514 accounts in 2025, one in five of Vietnam's new accounts, and ended the year with 1,512,920. In December 2025 only 85,739 (5.7 per cent) used any product, and 27,100 (1.8 per cent) held net assets of VND 10 million or more (Figure 3).

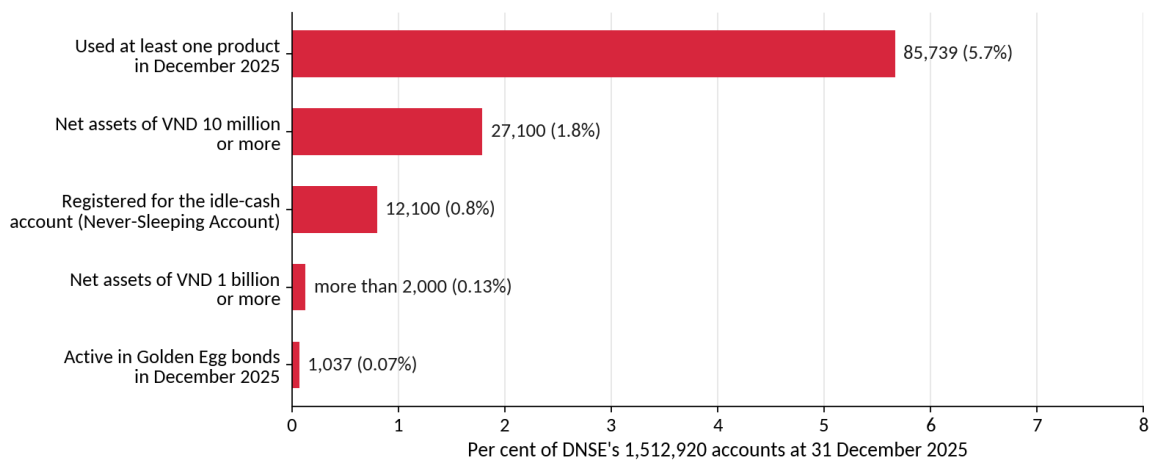


Figure 3. Activity, balances and product use among DNSE accounts, December 2025
Source: DNSE Securities (2026c).

The closer a measure sits to money, the smaller DNSE becomes (Figure 4). It holds 12.3 per cent of accounts but 2.3 per cent of investor cash, 1.4 per cent of margin lending and 0.6 per cent of industry profit. VPBankS and TCBS lend 8 and 12 times more per account, and VPS, which also has no parent bank, lends 5 times more (Table C2).

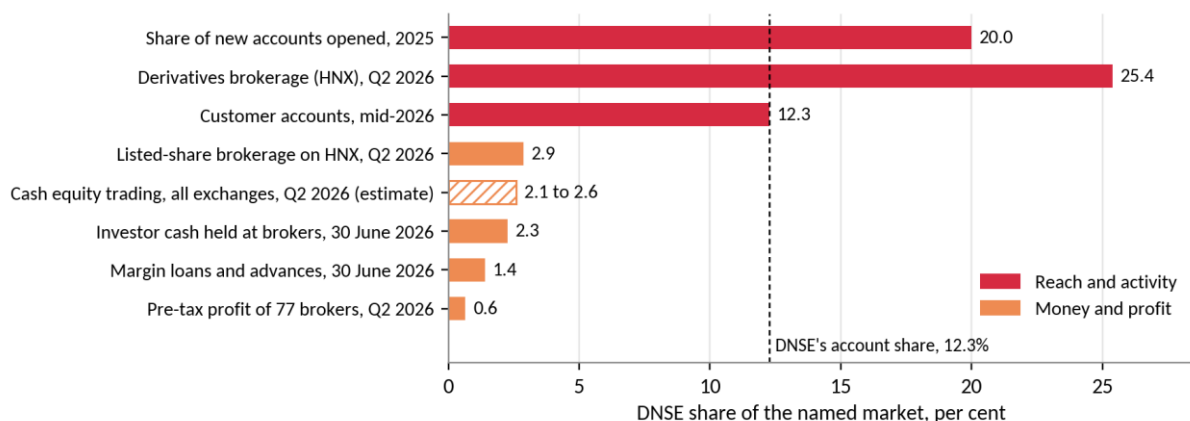


Figure 4. DNSE's share of eight markets, 2025 to mid-2026
Source: Table C1. Hatched bar estimated.

Insight: DNSE's acquisition works. Value is lost between opening an account and the first deposit.

2.3 Finding 2. Free trades lose money

Pre-tax profit excluding proprietary trading has stayed between VND 128 and 221 billion a year since 2022 (Table B1). Brokerage revenue has been below its direct cost for 16 consecutive quarters, a cumulative shortfall of VND 190 billion (Figure 5). Annualised return on equity fell to 3.8 per cent in the first half of 2026, below a 12-month deposit at a state bank.

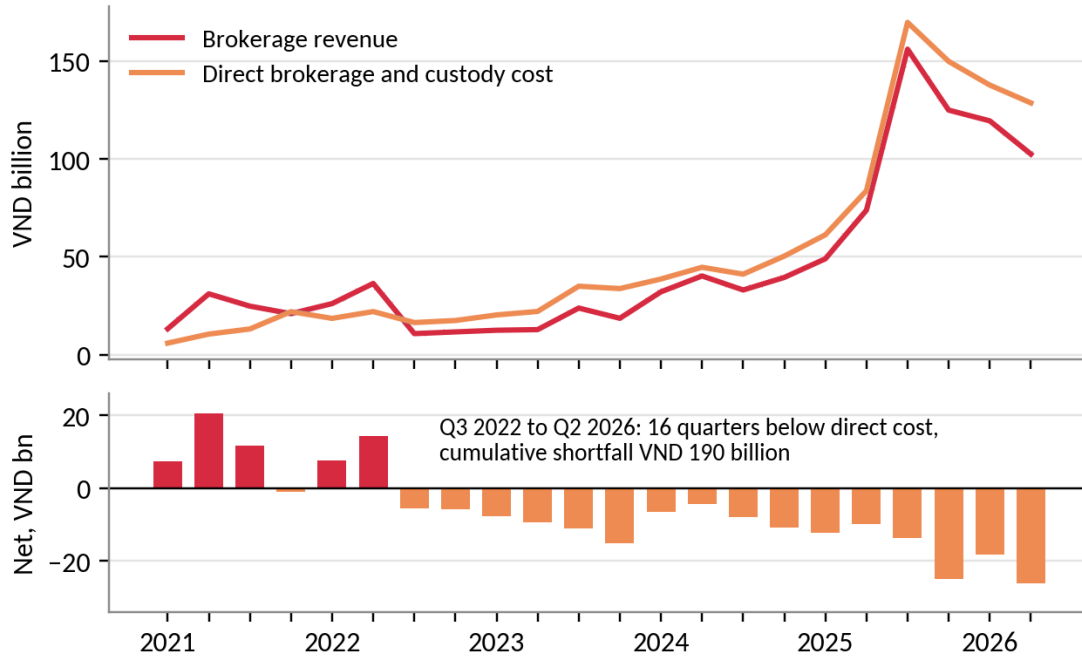


Figure 5. Brokerage revenue against direct brokerage cost, by quarter

Source: DNSE filings via Vietcap Securities (2026).

Insight: More trading does not raise profit, so profit growth has to come from customer balances.

2.4 Finding 3. Lending growth is capital-intensive

DNSE's estimated cost of funds rose from 3.6 per cent in mid-2024 to 6.5 per cent in the second quarter of 2026. Without a parent bank, it borrows short term against pledged deposits and bonds, which make up 37.6 per cent of its assets against 4 to 9 per cent at four large peers (Figure 6). Loans stood at 116 per cent of equity against a ceiling of 200 per cent, so DNSE has room to lend. It lacks customers with assets to borrow against.

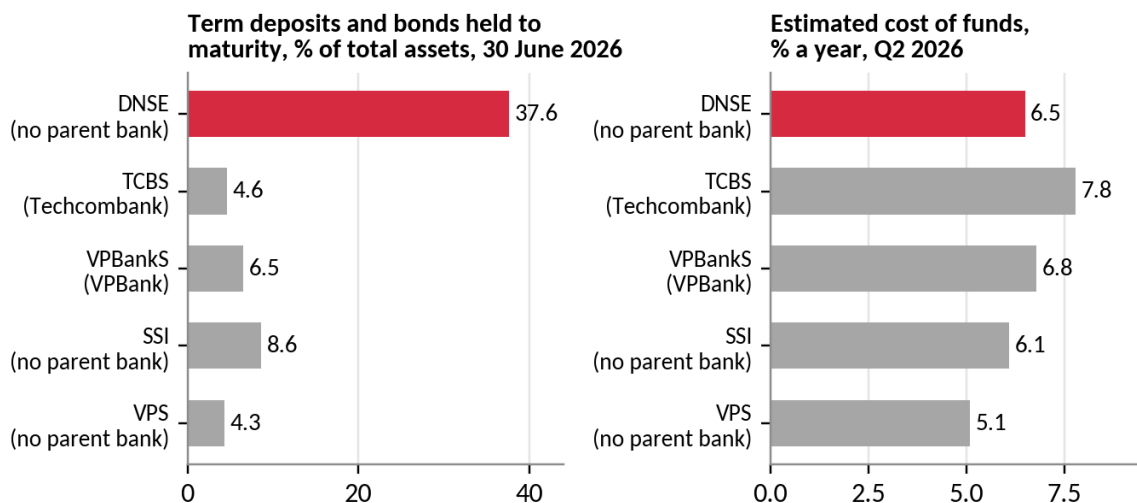


Figure 6. Funding structure of DNSE and four peers, second quarter of 2026

Source: filed statements via Vietcap Securities (2026); authors' calculations.

Insight: Fee income on customer balances uses less capital than margin growth, and margin demand follows customer assets.

2.5 Finding 4. Idle accounts make the platform a fixed cost

A proxy of staff costs, outsourced services and depreciation rose 12.5 times between 2021 and 2025, to VND 198 billion, while revenue rose 8.1 times (Table B3). The proxy equals VND 0.13 million per account but VND 7.3 million per account holding VND 10 million or more (Figure 7). It may include other overheads, so it indicates trend and scale only.

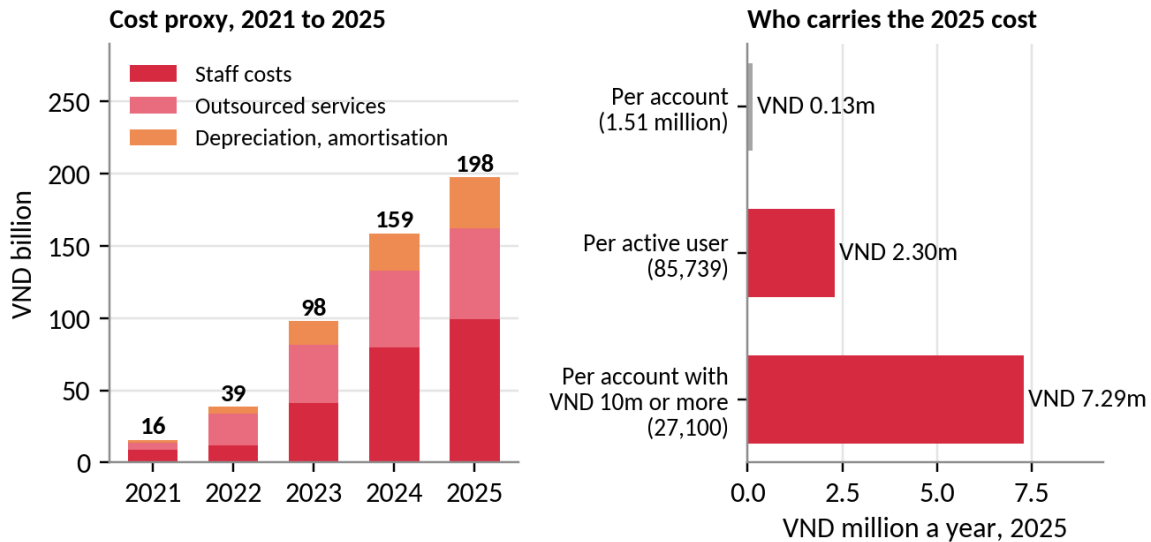


Figure 7. Platform and overhead cost proxy and the accounts that carry it
Source: DNSE filings; DNSE Securities (2026c); authors' calculations.

Insight: Fewer than 2 in 100 accounts carry the platform's cost, so funding existing accounts is the cheapest way to lower unit costs.

2.6 Finding 5. Trust complaints are specific to DNSE

In 278 negative DNSE reviews on Google Play, crashes and login failures appear in 27 per cent and identity checks in 21 per cent. Complaints about deception, sign-up bonus terms and the closure fee appear in 24 per cent but attract 43 per cent of helpful votes (Figure 8). The most-endorsed reviews describe a VND 100,000 reward that required a VND 2 million deposit and a VND 100,000 closure fee. Since 2025, reliability complaints have been at least as common at VPS (46 per cent) as at DNSE (38 per cent), yet VPS lends five times more per account. Trust complaints, however, reach 37 per cent at DNSE against 8 per cent at VPS and 1 per cent at FPT. A regulatory fine in August 2026 adds to these doubts (Market Times, 2026).

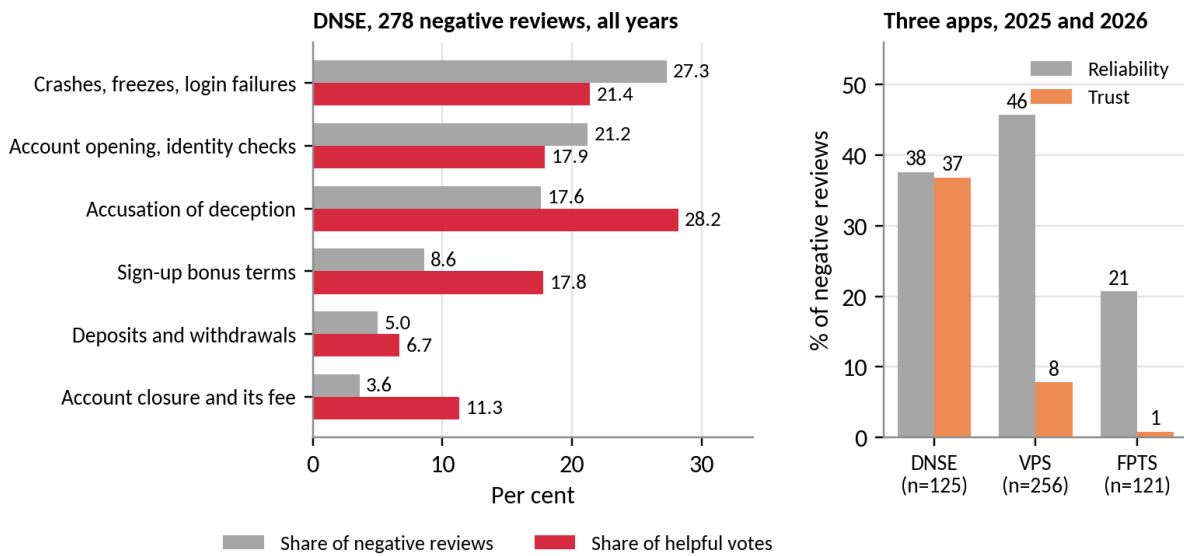


Figure 8. Complaint themes in negative Google Play reviews
Source: Google Play, retrieved 23 September 2026; authors' coding (Appendix D).

Insight: Trust complaints cluster at the first deposit and at withdrawal, the two moments that decide whether an account is funded.

2.7 Finding 6. Saving products exist but reach few customers

The Never-Sleeping Account had 12,100 registered users at the end of 2025, 0.8 per cent of accounts, and Golden Egg had 1,037 active customers in December (DNSE Securities, 2026c). Both products assume that the customer has already decided to deposit. Among Vietnamese adults, 70.5 per cent hold an account, but only 43.1 per cent save at a financial institution (World Bank, 2025). Three segments, the richest 60 per cent, adults in the labour force and adults with secondary education, each contain 15 to 20 million adults with an account and no formal saving (Figure 9). Among investors, 77 per cent find portfolio management difficult and 81 per cent want professional advice (Nhan Dan, 2025; VnEconomy, 2025).

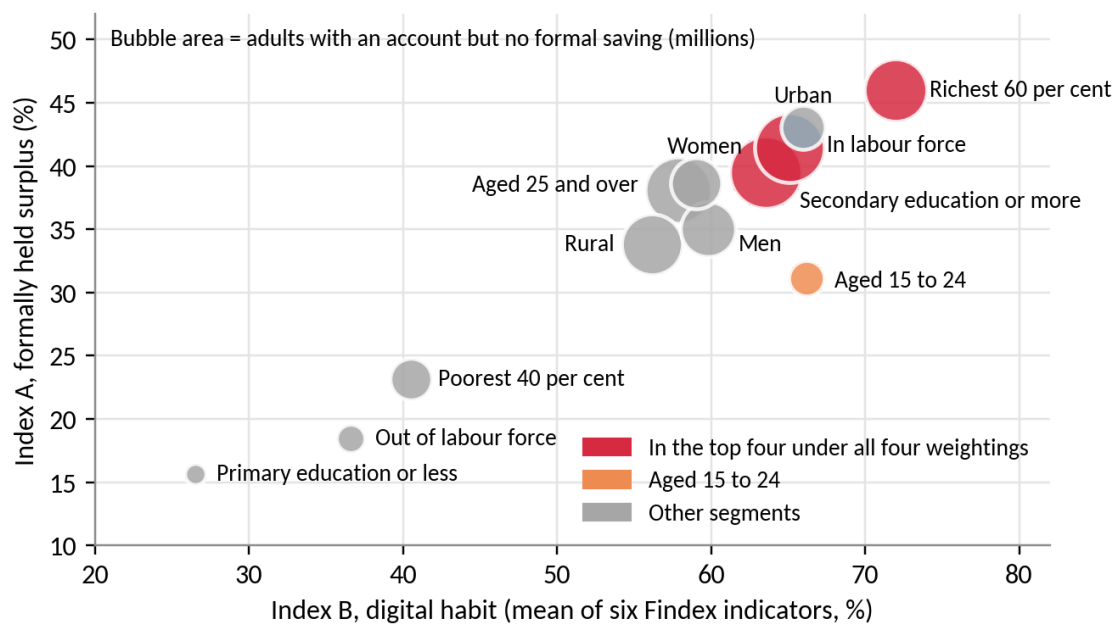


Figure 9. Vietnamese adult segments by digital habit and formally held surplus
Source: World Bank (2025); authors' indices (Appendix E).

Hypothesis: Many salaried adults, probably including many DNSE account holders, have an income, an account and an intention to invest, but they want guidance and keep postponing. The pattern is consistent with procrastination (O'Donoghue & Rabin, 1999).

3. DISCUSSION AND MAIN ANALYSIS

3.1 From symptom to root cause

Zero-fee acquisition makes opening an account costless, so a sign-up carries no commitment to fund it. Figure 10 traces the symptom to three root causes with different strengths of evidence.

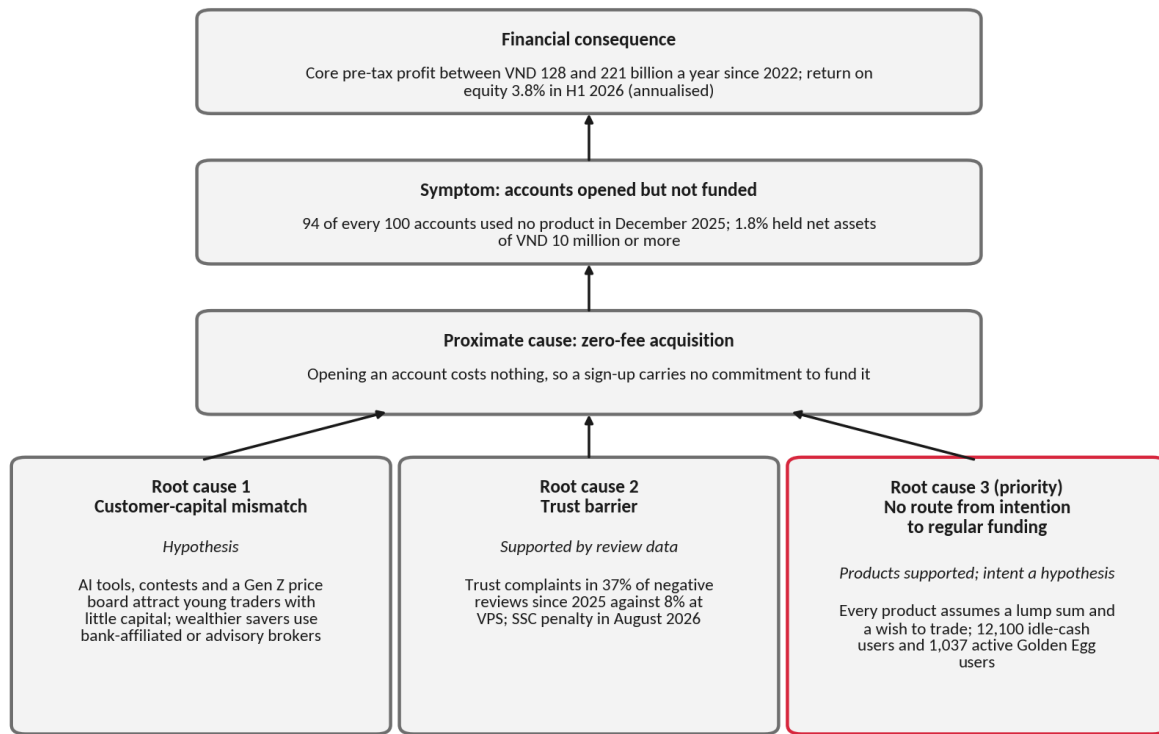


Figure 10. Root-cause tree for unfunded accounts
Source: authors' analysis of Section 2.

The customer-capital mismatch is a hypothesis, supported mainly by a Gen Z share of 31.5 per cent of accounts in mid-2025 (VnExpress, 2025). The trust barrier is supported by review data (Section 3.3). The missing route from intention to regular funding is supported for products and remains a hypothesis for customers (Section 3.4).

3.2 Account growth has not produced balances or profit

Findings 1 to 4 describe a single mechanism. Zero fees attract many small accounts, and each account adds to a platform cost that is largely fixed. Because free trades lose money, profit depends on margin loans, which require customers with assets to pledge and funding that DNSE secures with its own deposits. Between 2021 and 2025, accounts grew 33.8 times and the platform cost proxy 12.5 times, while core pre-tax profit grew 2.7 times (Figure 11).

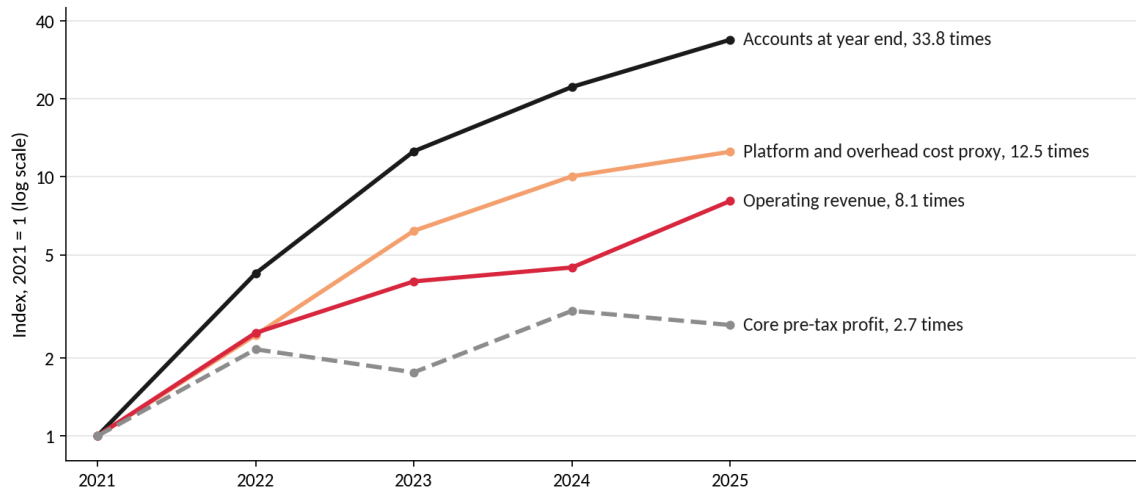


Figure 11. Accounts, revenue, platform cost and core profit, 2021 = 1
Source: Tables B1 and B3; authors' calculations.

The shortfall is large when measured in money. The average Vietnamese securities account held about VND 6.3 million of investor cash in mid-2026, against VND 1.2 million at DNSE. At the industry average, DNSE would hold about VND 10.6 trillion, 5.4 times its actual balance (Table C1). Each account that stays empty therefore adds cost without adding the balances on which DNSE earns.

3.3 Trust fails at the point of deposit

The mean rating of substantive DNSE reviews fell from 4.15 in 2024 to 2.38 in 2025, and the fall holds under every cleaning rule (Table A4). That year DNSE opened 518,514 accounts. The three most-endorsed complaints date from May and June 2025, and all three concern reward conditions or the closure fee (Table D3). VPS draws more reliability complaints than DNSE but lends five times more per account, which suggests that customers tolerate technical faults more readily than terms they consider unfair. The pattern is consistent with conditional rewards that raised sign-ups but weakened trust at the first deposit, so a solution should avoid them.

3.4 Intention without a route to investment

About 22.1 million Vietnamese adults hold an account but do not save formally (Table E1). Among the richest 60 per cent, 85.5 per cent hold an account and 49.5 per cent receive wages into one, yet only 53.8 per cent save at a financial institution. For these adults the salary already arrives in an account, so the missing step is a regular transfer from that account into an investment. When each deposit is a fresh decision, people who intend to save tend to postpone it (O'Donoghue & Rabin, 1999).

Evidence from other markets shows that product design can close this gap. Automatic enrolment raised pension-plan participation from 37 to 86 per cent (Madrian & Shea, 2001), and pre-committed saving raised saving rates from 3.5 to 13.6 per cent (Thaler & Benartzi, 2004). A commitment savings account raised balances by 81 percentage points against a control group after one year (Ashraf et al., 2006). Whether DNSE's dormant customers are salaried savers of this kind remains a hypothesis for Round 3.

3.5 Alternative explanations

Four other explanations were tested (Table F2). The market cycle does not explain the gap, since assets per account fell 9.5 per cent in 2025 while the VN-Index rose 41 per cent (Thanh Nien, 2025). A shortage of lending capital is also unlikely, as loans stood at 116 per cent of equity against a ceiling of 200 per cent. Dormancy common to all brokers does not fit either, because VPS, VPBankS and TCBS lend 5 to 12 times more per account. Only a deliberate plan to earn from young customers later cannot be rejected without cohort data.

3.6 Core problem and design conditions

Problem statement: Most DNSE accounts are never funded. At the end of 2025, 98 per cent held less than VND 10 million, so fewer than 2 in 100 carried the platform's cost. No DNSE product turns an intention to invest into regular deposits, and trust complaints deter the first deposit.

The problem is urgent. Open banking will let every competitor link salary accounts from March 2027, and DNSE had delivered 20 per cent of its 2026 profit target by mid-year (Vietstock, 2026a). Four conditions follow for any solution. It should bring money in without a large one-off decision, earn from balances without new pledged borrowing, rebuild trust through small and reversible steps without conditional rewards, and fit DNSE's licences.

4. RECOMMENDATIONS

4.1 Payday Portfolio

We recommend Payday Portfolio, a goal-based plan that moves part of each salary into a diversified portfolio on payday. It targets dormant account holders who receive a salary and extends to new salaried customers once a pilot confirms demand (Table E3). Each component meets a condition from Section 3.6 (Figure 12). The payday transfer brings money in without a monthly decision, advice through Ensa supplies guidance, and small, reversible contributions let customers test DNSE before they commit more. Because revenue comes from fees on funds and bonds, balances can grow without new pledged borrowing.

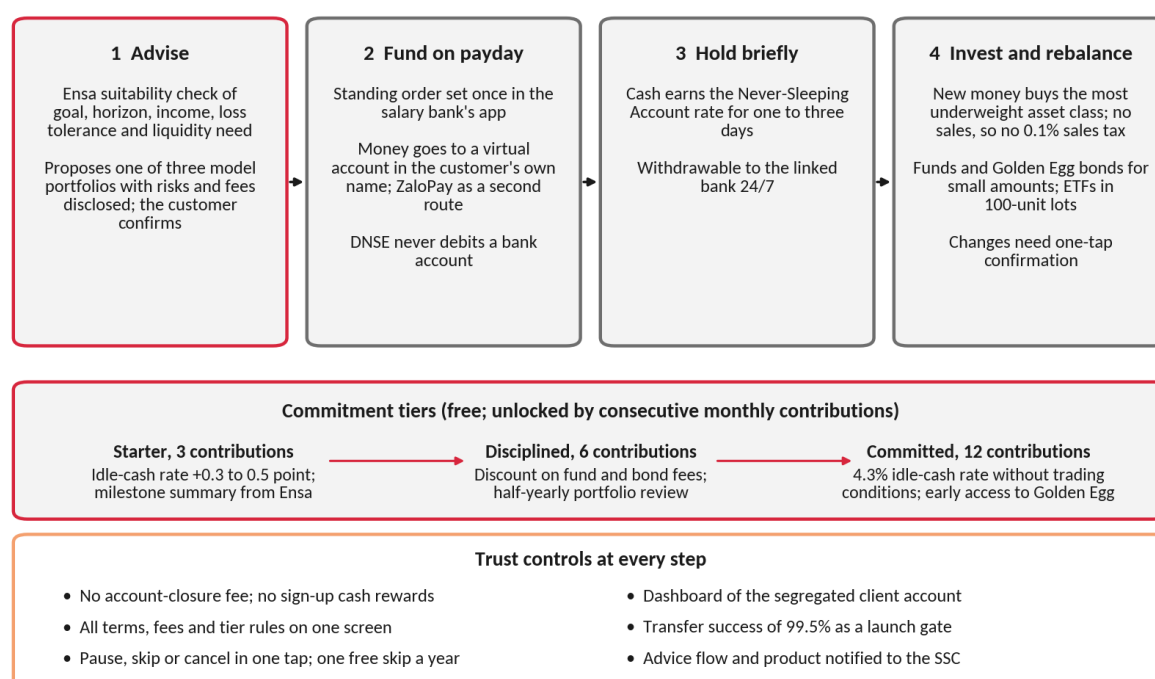


Figure 12. How Payday Portfolio works
Source: authors' design.

4.2 How Payday Portfolio works

Payday Portfolio runs inside DNSE's licensed advisory service, Investment Ideas (DNSE Securities, 2026d). As Circular 121/2020/TT-BTC requires, Ensa first records the customer's goal, time horizon, income and tolerance for losses (Ministry of Finance, 2020, Article 24). It then proposes a Conservative, Balanced or Growth model portfolio built from bond funds, Golden Egg bonds, equity funds and VN30 exchange-traded funds, and the customer confirms the choice. Single stocks are excluded.

After set-up, contributions arrive without further decisions. The customer chooses a monthly amount from VND 500,000 and creates a standing order once in the salary bank's app. The money goes to a virtual account number in the customer's own name at DNSE's partner bank, and is credited automatically, which reduces

the transfer errors behind complaints about uncredited deposits (Table D1). ZaloPay, a DNSE partner since 2023, offers a second route (Thanh Nien, 2023), and direct bank connections can follow from March 2027.

Arriving cash earns the Never-Sleeping Account rate for the one to three days before it is invested and remains withdrawable at any time. Ensa then directs each contribution to the asset class furthest below its target weight. Rebalancing with new money avoids sales, so the customer pays no 0.1 per cent tax on sales and no extra trading fees. Small amounts go to open-ended funds and to Golden Egg bonds from VND 1 million, while exchange-traded fund purchases wait until the balance covers a 100-unit lot. The plan executes only the amounts and products the customer has chosen, and any change of allocation needs a one-tap confirmation, because a securities company may not invest on a client's behalf (Ministry of Finance, 2020, Article 4).

Commitment tiers reward persistence without a membership fee. Customers unlock three tiers through consecutive monthly contributions, so every reward depends on money that stays. The Starter tier, after three contributions, covers the 90-day point at which customers test deposits and withdrawals, and it adds 0.3 to 0.5 percentage points to the idle-cash rate. The Disciplined tier, after six contributions, adds a discount on fund and bond fees and a half-yearly portfolio review. The Committed tier, after twelve contributions, pays the top idle-cash rate of 4.3 per cent without the current balance and trading conditions and gives early access to new Golden Egg issues. A visible streak makes the next contribution the default, and the prospect of losing a tier weighs more than an equal gain (Kahneman & Tversky, 1979). Each customer may skip one month a year without losing a tier, which protects savers whose income varies. Rewards exclude margin, since leverage conflicts with a saver's goal. Success is measured by balances, because six contributions of VND 1 million still leave a saver below VND 10 million (Figure 13).

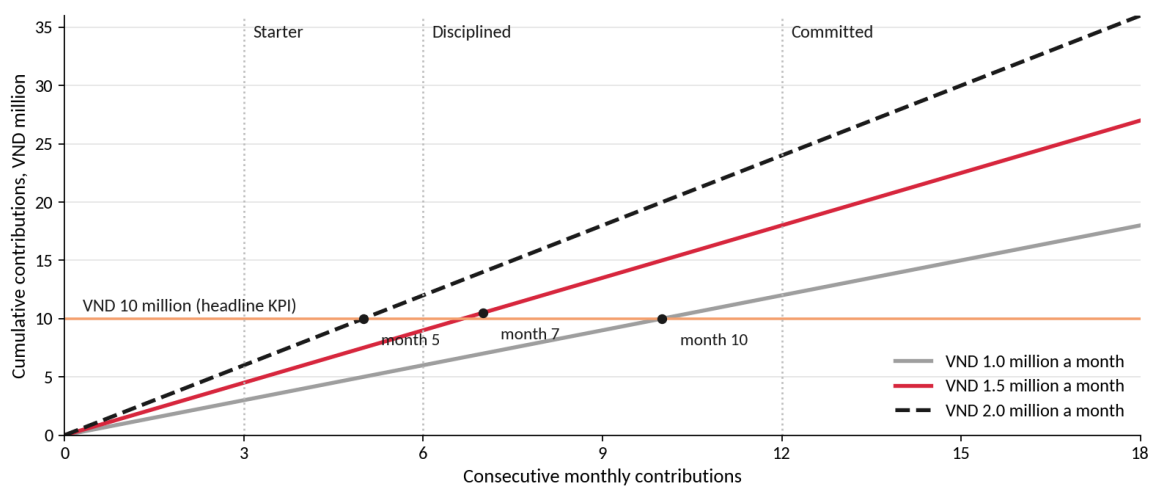


Figure 13. Contributions needed to reach VND 10 million, before investment returns

Source: authors' calculations.

Trust controls cover each step at which complaints arise. DNSE removes the account-closure fee and replaces conditional sign-up rewards with tier rewards. All terms, fees and tier rules appear on one screen, and customers can pause, skip or cancel in one tap. A dashboard shows the segregated client account that holds the customer's cash, and transfer success of 99.5 per cent is a condition for launch.

4.3 How Payday Portfolio resolves the core problem

The cost is modest. Tier interest would cost at most VND 5.6 billion a year for 150,000 savers, while a VND 100,000 reward on every account opened in 2025 would have cost VND 51.9 billion (Appendix F1).

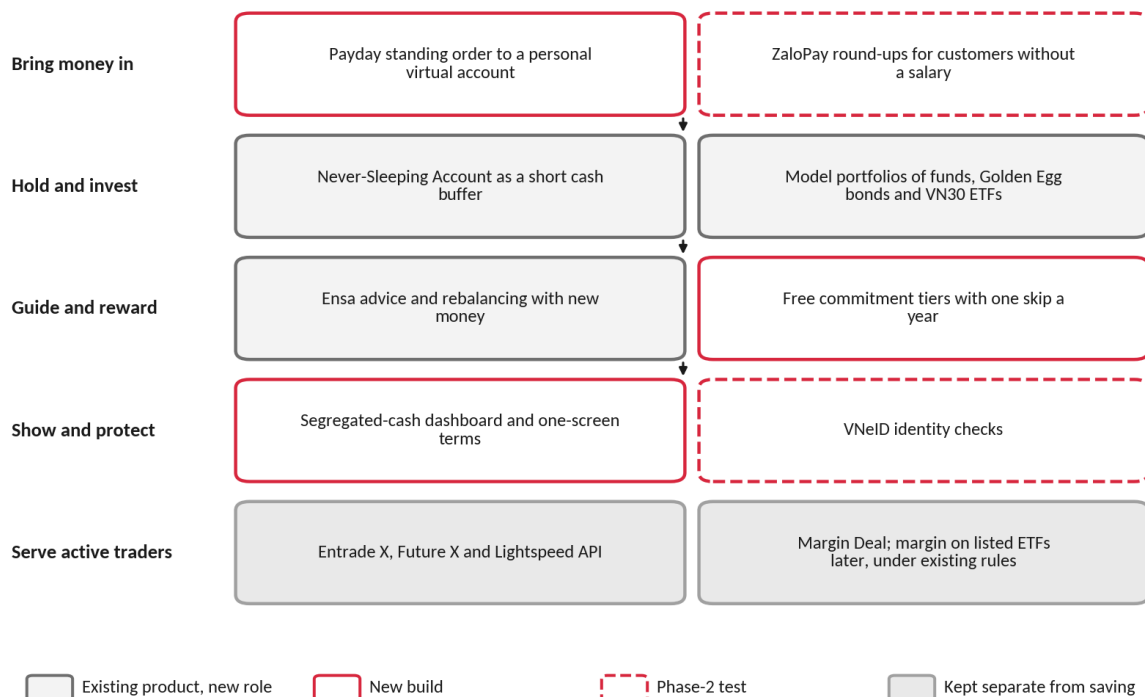
Table 1. The problem statement and the Payday Portfolio response

Part of the problem	Payday Portfolio response	Evidence
98 per cent of accounts hold less than VND 10 million	A payday standing order brings money in without a monthly decision	Automatic enrolment raised participation from 37 to 86 per cent (Madrian & Shea, 2001)
No product turns intention into regular deposits	Goal-based model portfolios through Ensa; rebalancing with new money	77 per cent of investors find portfolio management difficult (Section 2.7)
Trust complaints deter the first deposit	Small, reversible transfers; no closure fee; one-screen terms; segregated-cash dashboard	Trust complaints in 37 per cent of negative reviews, against 8 per cent at VPS (Section 2.6)
Fewer than 2 in 100 accounts carry the platform's cost	Balances build in accounts already acquired; fee income needs no pledged borrowing	Base case lifts accounts above VND 10 million to about 177,000 and cuts platform cost per funded account from VND 7.3 million to 1.1 million (Table F5)

Source: Sections 2 and 3; Appendix F; authors' design.

4.4 Extending DNSE's technology ecosystem

DNSE's technology rests on four platforms, namely Entrade X for zero-fee share trading, Future X for derivatives, Margin Deal for deal-by-deal margin loans and the Ensa assistant. It also runs Lightspeed API for algorithmic trading, two saving products and a distribution link with ZaloPay (DNSE Securities, 2026e). Most of this technology serves active traders, while the zero-fee policy has attracted young customers with small balances. As a result, the platform behaves as a fixed cost carried by few funded accounts (Finding 4). Payday Portfolio gives these components a shared purpose, which is to bring in and keep customer balances (Figure 14). Three upgrades extend this role.

**Figure 14.** DNSE's technology ecosystem organised around customer balances

Source: authors' design; Appendix G.

First, ZaloPay round-ups can serve as an entry route for customers without a regular salary. Each payment is rounded up to the nearest VND 10,000, and the difference collects in the Never-Sleeping Account until it reaches VND 100,000, when it buys fund units in the customer's model portfolio. Round-ups remove the barrier of a first lump-sum deposit, but the amounts are small. At an assumed 30 payments a month and an average round-up of VND 5,000, a customer would add about VND 150,000 a month, so round-ups complement the payday transfer and should be tested in phase 2.

Second, the Smart Vault idea can be offered in a compliant form. Rule-based strategies, such as a high-dividend or VN30 momentum strategy, can become additional model portfolios under the advisory licence, with each order confirmed by the customer. Automatic execution for an asset-based fee raises a licensing issue, because portfolio management is not among the four businesses permitted to securities companies (National Assembly, 2019, Article 72). A fully managed version should therefore come from a licensed fund manager whose funds DNSE distributes.

Third, a transparency layer turns the trust controls into evidence that customers can check. The segregated-cash dashboard shows where each customer's cash is held, the interest earned and the status of every withdrawal. Identity checks through the national VNeID application should also be tested, since account opening and identity checks appear in 21 per cent of negative reviews (Table D1).

A credit line secured on savings is not recommended. Circular 121/2020/TT-BTC restricts lending by securities companies to margin loans and a few defined purposes (Ministry of Finance, 2020, Article 27), open-ended fund units are not listed securities, and the 2026 fine concerned unreported advance services. Margin on listed exchange-traded funds can follow later under existing rules (Appendix G).

5. CONCLUSION

DNSE acquires customers at scale, but fewer than 2 in 100 accounts carry its platform and borrowing costs. Payday Portfolio acts on the cause DNSE controls most by combining licensed advice, payday automation, free commitment tiers and trust controls. The ecosystem upgrades direct DNSE's existing technology towards customer balances. Appendix F sets out the scenarios, KPIs and pilot tests for Round 3.

APPENDICES

Appendix A. Data preparation and quality

Table A1. Evidence base and preparation

Dataset	Coverage	Main preparation step	Remaining limitation
DNSE filed statements	395 line items, first quarter of 2018 to second quarter of 2026	Pulled line by line from Vietcap IQ; reconciled to the half-year statements reviewed by KPMG	Template line 24 mixes provisions with borrowing cost
DNSE annual report 2025	Accounts, active customers, net-asset bands, product users	Figures read from the report and dated	Company-defined measures; active means at least one product used in the month
Peer statements and indicators	Four peers; accounts, lending, funding, profit	Same cost-of-funds method as for DNSE; each figure dated	Account counts differ in date and definition
Exchange and industry data	HOSE and HNX shares; industry lending, investor cash and profit	Each share kept within its own exchange; broadest industry total used	Press tallies differ slightly in coverage
App store reviews	867 Google Play and 332 App Store reviews of DNSE; 2,100 of VPS and FPT	Spam and duplicates removed; one-word reviews flagged; themes coded	Self-selected sample; levels overstate dissatisfaction
World Bank Global Findex 2024	51 indicators across 13 segments for Vietnam	Two indices built; segment weights recovered from the survey	About 1,000 interviews; one dimension at a time
Macro and banking data	Growth, inflation, credit, deposit rates, deposits	Dated at source; projections labelled	Some series reported only through the press

Source: compiled by the authors; access dates 20 to 25 September 2026.

A1. Reconciliation. Where press reports and the filings differ, the reviewed filings are used (Table A2). The half-year statements reviewed by KPMG raise administrative expenses by VND 1.5 billion against the quarterly statement of 20 July 2026. The press figure of VND 1,467 billion for 2025 revenue includes financial income, and the filings report VND 1,457.9 billion of operating revenue.

Table A2. Press figures reconciled with the filings, VND billion

Item	Press or earlier data	Filings used	Reason for the difference
Pre-tax profit, Q2 2026	98.9	97.4	Reviewed half year less the first quarter
Pre-tax profit, H1 2026	113.1	111.6	Reviewed statements of 14 August 2026
Operating revenue, 2025	1,467.0	1,457.9	Press total includes financial income
Revenue growth, 2025	77%	80.6%	Follows from the line above
Proprietary provisions, Q1 2026	plus 405%	not used	No line of the filings reproduces the figure

Source: DNSE filings via Vietcap Securities (2026); DNSE Securities (2026a); press reports cited in Section 2.

A2. Transformations. The cost of funds equals interest expense plus template line 24, less the rise in the balance-sheet allowance for loan losses, multiplied by four and divided by average borrowings and bonds. The net interest margin deducts this cost from interest on loans, deposits and bonds held to maturity, over average interest-earning assets. Core pre-tax profit excludes the net result on financial assets at fair value through profit or loss. Per-account values divide a balance or flow by accounts at the same date. The same formulas are applied to peers.

A3. Concentration bound. At the end of 2025 DNSE reported 1,512,920 accounts, of which 27,100 held net assets of VND 10 million or more, and customer assets of VND 53,471 billion. The other 1,485,820 accounts each hold less than VND 10 million net, or at most VND 14,858 billion together. Their gross assets can exceed net assets only by what they borrow, and total lending was VND 5,832 billion. They can therefore hold at most VND 20,690 billion, so accounts with VND 10 million or more hold at least VND 32,781 billion, or 61 per cent of customer assets. The bound is conservative because it assigns every loan to the smaller accounts.

A4. Denominators, missing values and outliers. HOSE and HNX report market share within their own exchange, so shares are never compared across exchanges. Industry lending (VND 453.8 trillion including

advances) and investor cash (VND 86.6 trillion) use the broader published totals, and narrower totals raise DNSE's shares by about 0.1 point. The industry cash total for the fourth quarter of 2025 and DNSE's derivatives share for the second and third quarters of 2024 were not published and are left missing. DNSE's investor cash fell to VND 429 billion in the first quarter of 2025 and recovered the next quarter. The value appears in the filings and probably reflects settlement timing. It stays in the series and is excluded from trend statements.

A5. Platform cost proxy. DNSE does not report technology spending. The proxy sums staff costs and outsourced services from the note on general and administrative expenses and total depreciation and amortisation from the cash flow statement. It may include non-technology overheads and exclude technology staff costs booked under brokerage expenses, so it is used for trend and order of magnitude only.

Table A3. Review cleaning log

Stage	DNSE, Play	VPS, Play	FPTS, Play	DNSE, iOS	VPS, iOS	FPTS, iOS
Reviews retrieved	867	1,200	177	332	518	205
Loan advertising removed	127	23	0	0	0	0
Referral farming removed	70	3	0	73	6	0
Duplicates removed	0	3	0	0	0	0
Reviews retained	670	1,171	177	259	512	205
Mean rating before cleaning	3.29	2.60	2.18	3.37	1.57	2.31
Mean rating after cleaning	3.22	2.58	2.18	2.94	1.53	2.31

Source: Google Play (23 September 2026) and Apple App Store (24 September 2026); authors' cleaning code. Text was normalised (Unicode compatibility composition, diacritics removed, lower case) before two rules flagged loan advertising and referral farming. The referral rule fires only where a referral phrase sits next to a code or reward amount and passes 37 test cases. Copy-and-paste duplicates of 20 characters or more were removed, and identical short reviews by different people were kept. VPS is its 1,200 most recent Google Play reviews, from 27 March 2023.

Cleaning changed the conclusions. In 2022 and 2023, 46 and 54 per cent of DNSE's Google Play reviews were spam, and the removed material was rated higher than the genuine reviews (3.53 against 3.22), so cleaning lowers DNSE's rating. Table A4 tests the rule that flags generic reviews.

Table A4. Sensitivity of the generic-review rule, DNSE Google Play

Rule for a generic review	Generic share, 2024	Generic share, 2025	Substantive mean, 2024	Substantive mean, 2025
One word (rule used)	33.7%	12.0%	4.15	2.38
Up to two words	50.3%	17.7%	4.00	2.22
Up to four words	62.7%	25.9%	3.74	2.01

Source: authors' cleaning code. The fall in substantive ratings from 2024 to 2025 holds under every rule.

Appendix B. DNSE financial data

Table B1. Income statement summary, VND billion

Item	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	H1 2026
Operating revenue	180.7	452.1	714.5	807.4	1,457.9	848.2
Interest on margin loans and advances	42.7	223.1	286.2	360.5	555.8	336.1
Interest on deposits and bonds held to maturity	20.1	112.9	196.0	245.0	303.9	193.4
Brokerage revenue	90.0	84.8	67.6	144.8	404.0	222.1
Direct brokerage cost	51.5	74.4	111.1	174.8	464.9	266.5
Interest expense plus line 24	23.9	172.2	233.6	210.6	429.8	324.1
Administrative expenses	14.8	37.1	94.3	151.9	181.4	95.4
Pre-tax profit	68.2	95.0	285.6	227.5	340.2	111.6
Net proprietary result	(4.4)	(61.3)	158.0	6.8	146.2	33.9
Core pre-tax profit	72.5	156.3	127.6	220.7	194.0	77.7

Source: DNSE filed statements via Vietcap Securities (2026); H1 2026 from the half-year statements reviewed by KPMG; authors' calculations. Core pre-tax profit excludes the net result on financial assets at fair value through profit or loss. Negative values are in parentheses.

Table B2. Balance sheet and main ratios

Item	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	Jun 2026
Margin loans and advances, VND bn	1,192	2,280	2,483	3,882	5,832	6,303
Deposits and bonds held to maturity, VND bn	883	2,824	3,495	5,103	6,266	5,714
Total assets, VND bn	2,315	6,409	7,446	10,637	15,139	15,208
Borrowings and bonds, VND bn	1,224	2,735	3,643	6,494	10,600	9,446
Owners' equity, VND bn	1,059	3,136	3,305	4,030	4,302	5,440
Investor cash (off balance sheet), VND bn	435	251	790	1,340	2,903	1,961
Pre-tax margin, %	37.7	21.0	40.0	28.2	23.3	13.2
Brokerage revenue as % of direct cost	174.9	114.0	60.9	82.8	86.9	83.3
Return on equity, %	8.9	3.7	7.1	5.0	6.5	3.8
Loans as % of equity (ceiling 200)	112.6	72.7	75.1	96.3	135.6	115.9
Estimated cost of funds, %	6.5	6.8	7.3	4.1	5.1	6.3
Net interest margin, %	6.2	5.4	4.8	5.0	4.2	3.5

Source: as Table B1. Return on equity, cost of funds and net interest margin in the last column cover the first half of 2026, annualised. Section 2.4 and Table C2 quote the second quarter alone, when the cost of funds was 6.5 per cent.

Table B3. Platform and overhead cost proxy, VND billion

Item	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Staff costs (administration)	8.6	12.1	41.2	80.0	99.4
Outsourced services	4.8	21.5	40.4	52.8	62.7
Depreciation and amortisation (all)	2.4	5.0	16.2	25.9	35.4
Platform cost proxy	15.8	38.7	97.8	158.8	197.5
Software and leased equipment at cost	20.0	44.7	95.7	129.1	168.5
Accounts at year end	44,727	189,845	561,279	994,811	1,512,920
Active customers, December	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	about 41,900	85,739
Proxy per active customer, VND million	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	3.79	2.30

Source: DNSE filed statements (notes on administrative expenses; cash flow statement; notes on intangible and finance-lease assets); DNSE Securities (2026c); authors' calculations.

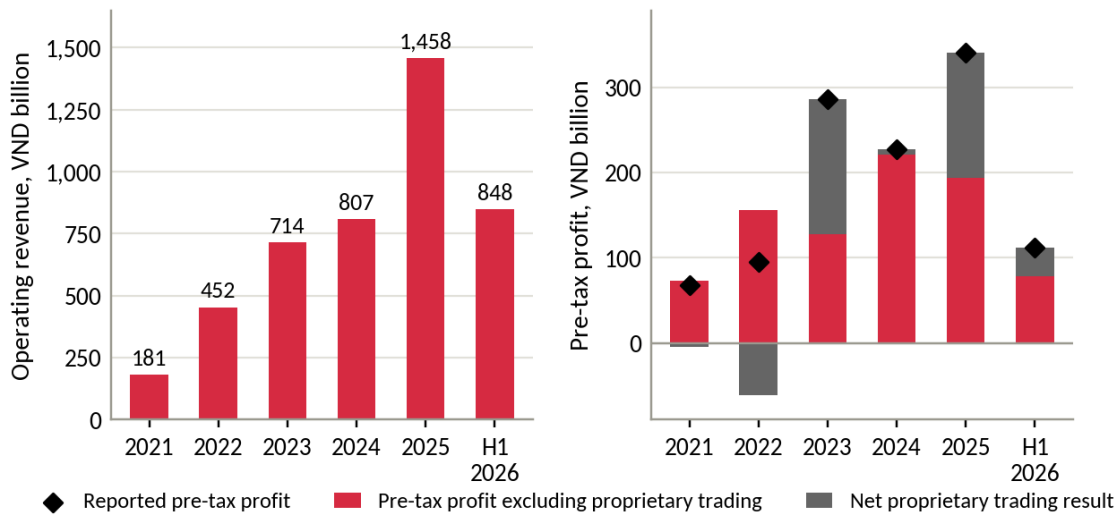


Figure B1. Operating revenue and pre-tax profit split into core business and proprietary trading

Source: DNSE filings; authors' calculations.

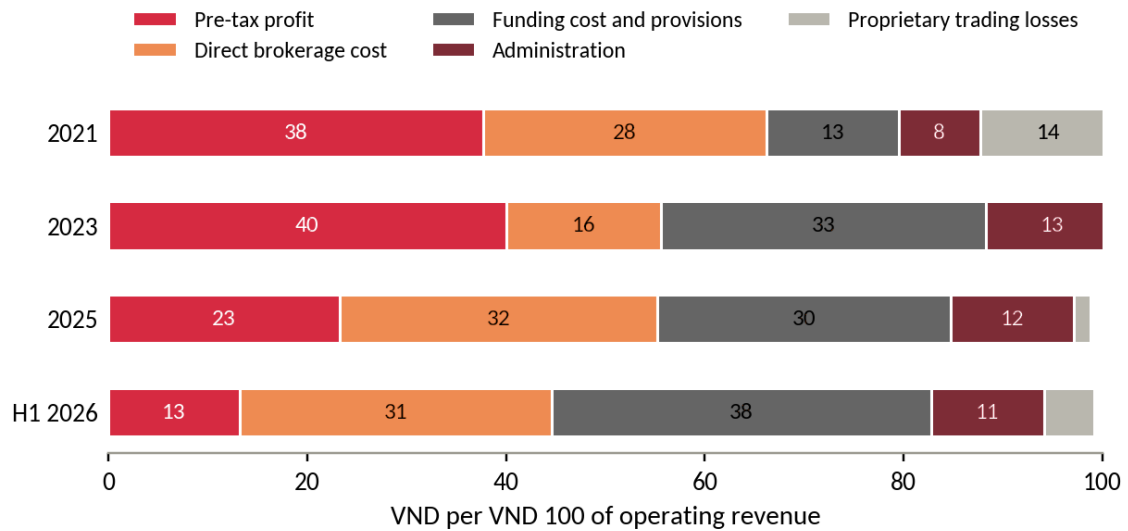


Figure B2. Where each VND 100 of operating revenue goes

Source: DNSE filings; authors' calculations.

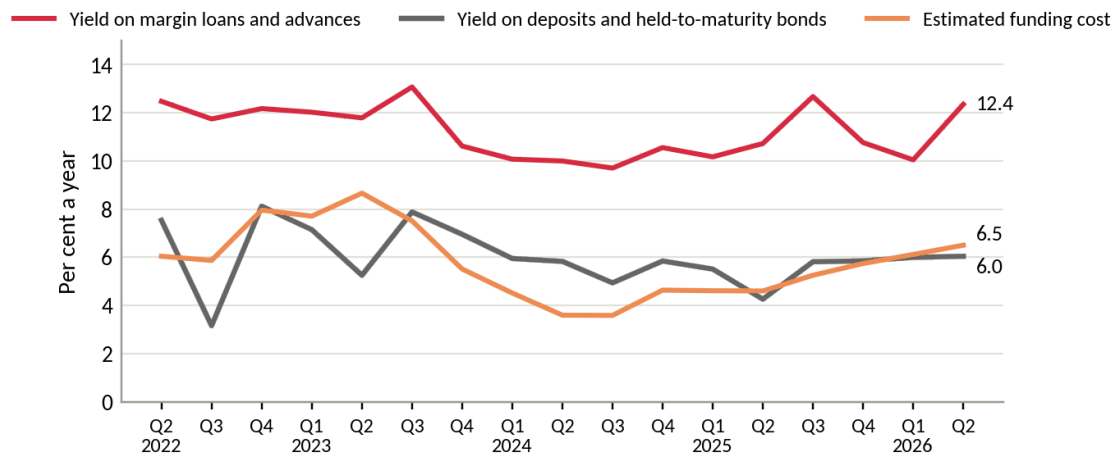


Figure B3. Yield on margin loans and on deposits and bonds held to maturity, against the estimated cost of funds

Source: DNSE filings; authors' calculations.

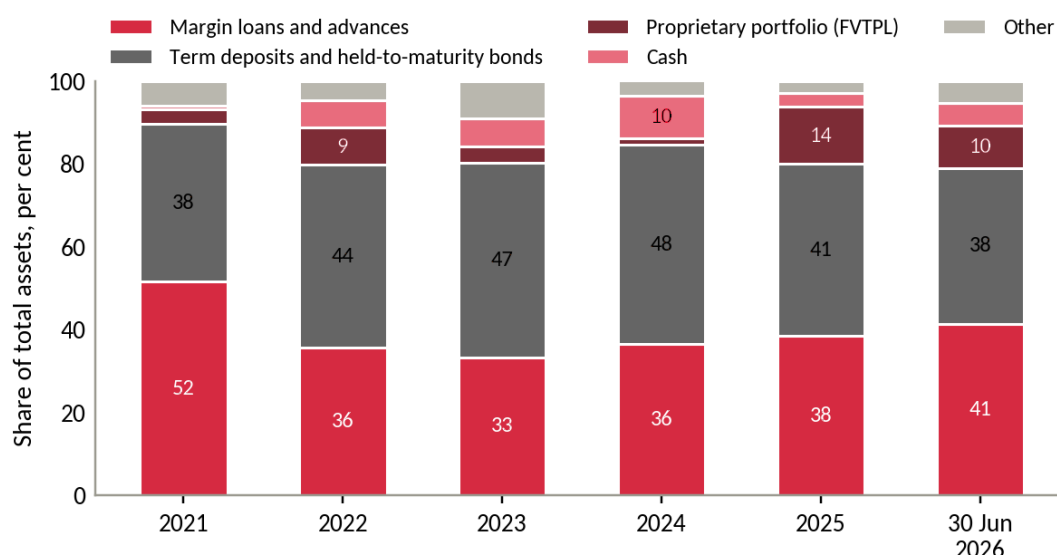


Figure B4. Composition of DNSE total assets
Source: DNSE filings.

Appendix C. Market and peer data

Table C1. DNSE's position on eight measures

Measure	DNSE	Market total	DNSE share, %	Ratio to account share
Securities accounts, mid-2026	1.70 million	13.85 million	12.27	1.00
New accounts, 2025	518,514	2,573,945	20.14	1.64
Derivatives brokerage, Q2 2026	2nd place	HNX	25.38	2.07
Listed-share brokerage on HNX, Q2 2026	8th place	HNX	2.88	0.23
Cash equity trading, Q2 2026 (estimate)	VND 62.9 trillion	all exchanges	2.1 to 2.6	0.17 to 0.21
Investor cash at brokers, 30 June 2026	VND 1,961 billion	VND 86.6 trillion	2.26	0.18
Margin lending, 30 June 2026	VND 6,303 billion	VND 453.8 trillion	1.39	0.11
Pre-tax profit, Q2 2026	VND 97.4 billion	VND 15,200 billion	0.64	0.05

Source: VnExpress (2026a); DNSE Securities (2026c); Vietstock (2026c); CafeF (2026); VnEconomy (2026); Hanoi Stock Exchange (2026); DNSE filings; authors' calculations. The trading estimate divides the value of shares DNSE's customers traded by twice the value traded on HOSE plus 7 per cent for HNX and UPCoM.

Table C2. DNSE against named peers

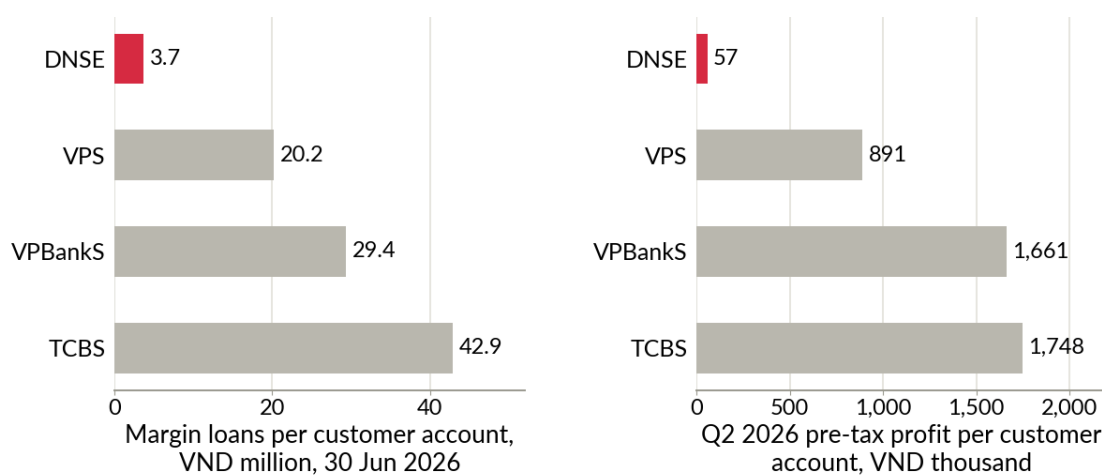
Indicator	DNSE	VPBankS	TCBS	VPS
Customer accounts, million	1.70	1.30	1.20	1.55
Margin lending, 30 June 2026, VND bn	6,303	38,200	51,500	31,300
Lending per account, VND million	3.7	29.4	42.9	20.2
Pre-tax profit per account, Q2 2026, VND thousand	57	1,661	1,748	891
Deposits and bonds held to maturity, % of assets	37.6	6.5	4.6	4.3
Estimated cost of funds, Q2 2026, %	6.5	6.8	7.8	5.1
Parent bank	none	VPBank	Techcombank	none

Source: filed statements via Vietcap Securities (2026); company releases for account counts (VPBankS May 2026; TCBS end-2025; VPS September 2025); Vietstock (2026c); authors' calculations. Per-account values are averages that large clients raise at every firm. SSI, with no parent bank, holds 8.6 per cent of assets in deposits and bonds and has a cost of funds of 6.1 per cent.

Table C3. Competitive landscape of Vietnamese retail brokerage and savings

Model	Examples	How it earns	Strength	Gap for salaried savers
Bank-affiliated brokers	TCBS, VPBankS, MBS	Margin lending, bond distribution	Cheap funding, capital, parent-bank customers and trust	Serve mainly their parents' customers; TCBS iPower pays interest only above VND 5 million
Independent full-service brokers	SSI, HSC, Vietcap	Margin, institutional brokerage, advisory	Research, brand, human	Costly to serve small savers
Retail trading platforms	VPS	Retail and derivatives brokerage, margin	Largest retail share	Trading-first; no link from a salary
Zero-fee digital brokers	DNSE, Pinetree	Margin, derivatives	Low cost, fast technology, young customers	Small balances; no regular-saving product
Banks' automatic-earning accounts	Large commercial banks	Deposit spread	Salary accounts, trust	Little choice beyond deposits

Source: company statements and product pages; TCBS (2026); Vietstock (2026b); authors' assessment.


Figure C1. Lending and profit per customer account, DNSE against VPS, VPBankS and TCBS

Source: as Table C2.

Appendix D. Customer review analysis

Table D1. Themes in DNSE's negative Google Play reviews

Theme	Negative reviews	Share of negative reviews, %	Share of helpful votes, %
Crashes, freezes, login failures, slow orders	76	27.3	21.4
Account opening, identity checks, one-time passwords	59	21.2	17.9
Explicit accusation of deception	49	17.6	28.2
Sign-up bonus terms, rewards not received	24	8.6	17.8
Deposits not credited, withdrawal delays	14	5.0	6.7
Cannot close the account, closure fee	10	3.6	11.3
Any trust theme (deception, bonus terms, closure)	67	24.1	42.9
Any product theme (stability, onboarding)	118	42.4	34.1
Idle-cash product (Never-Sleeping Account), all reviews	3 mentions, all positive		

Source: Google Play, retrieved 23 September 2026; authors' coding. 278 one- and two-star reviews carrying 1,794 helpful votes. Themes are not exclusive.

Table D2. Reliability and trust complaints at three brokers, January 2025 to September 2026

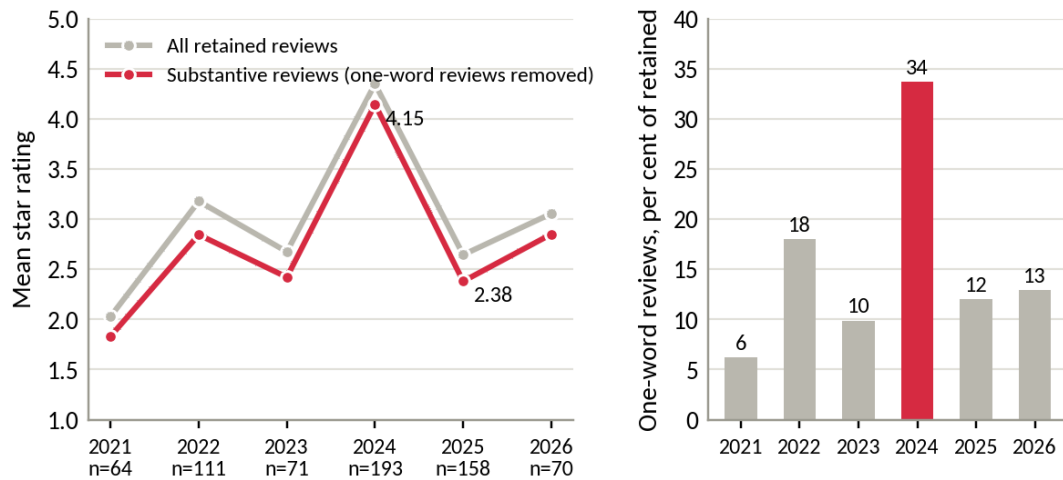
Application	Negative reviews	Reliability, % of reviews	Reliability, % of votes	Trust, % of reviews	Trust, % of votes	App mean, 2025 to 2026	Store
DNSE Entrade X	125	37.6	30.2	36.8	50.4	2.25	
VPS SmartOne	256	45.7	45.1	7.8	7.3	1.47	
FPTS EzTrade	121	20.7	17.7	0.8	1.8	2.31	

Source: Google Play (retrieved 23 September 2026) and Apple App Store (retrieved 24 September 2026); authors' cleaning and coding. Reliability covers crashes, freezes, login failures, slow orders and account opening. Trust covers accusations of deception, sign-up bonus terms and account closure.

Table D3. Selected DNSE reviews, translated from Vietnamese

Date	Stars	Helpful votes	Review
9 Jun 2025	1	58	"Everyone, be careful, it is a scam. You do not receive the 100k. To delete your account you have to pay it 100k."
24 May 2025	1	54	"I have been trapped ... you cannot cancel the registration ... after approval you have to go to the head office to delete the account."
28 Jun 2025	1	50	"Deceptive and false. There is no 100k straight away. You have to deposit at least 2 million to get it."
2 Jun 2025	2	18	"When I deposit outside trading hours, the money leaves my bank account but the securities account does not receive it."
15 May 2026	5	13	"... The idle account is the best. Watching the interest rise in real time is satisfying, and money earns interest automatically once it is deposited."

Source: Google Play; translated by the authors.

**Figure D1.** Mean rating of DNSE reviews by year, and the share of one-word reviews

Source: Google Play; authors' cleaning.

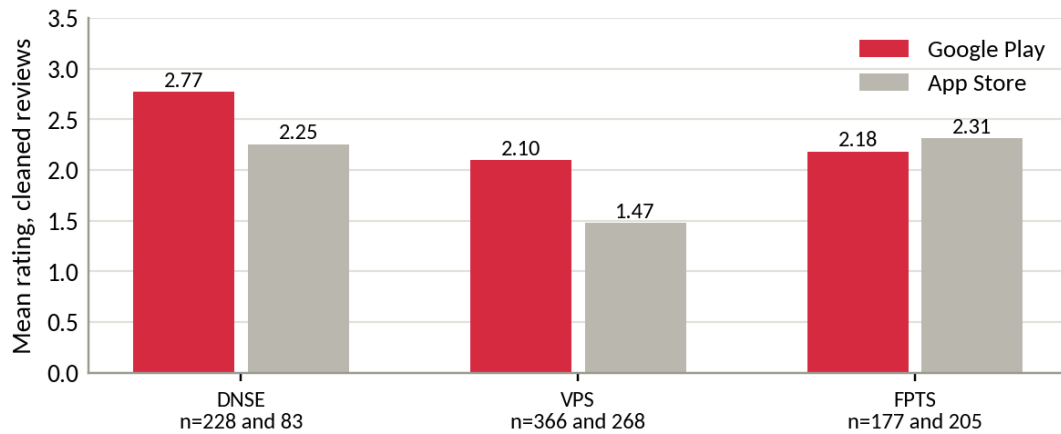


Figure D2. Mean rating of cleaned reviews on Google Play and the App Store, 2025 and 2026

Source: Google Play and Apple App Store; authors' cleaning.

Regulatory record. Decision 461/QD-XPHC of the State Securities Inspectorate, issued on 17 August 2026, fined DNSE VND 802.5 million. The largest item, VND 275 million, concerned three services supporting derivatives brokerage (advances against open-position gains, out-of-hours advances on margin withdrawals and advances of margin deposits), offered from January 2024 to June 2026 without reporting to the State Securities Commission. DNSE was ordered to stop all three. Other items covered margin loans and advances to insiders and related persons from January 2024 to June 2026, buy orders placed without sufficient funds, margin trading beyond purchasing power and loans for securities that did not qualify (Market Times, 2026; Phu Nu Viet Nam, 2026). An earlier fine of VND 125 million concerned margin lending on a stock removed from the marginable list (Thuong Hieu & Cong Luan, 2024).

Appendix E. Index segment analysis

Table E1. Index indicators for selected segments, Vietnam, 2024 fieldwork (per cent of adults)

Segment	Share of adults	Index A (surplus)	Index B (digital)	Has an account	Saved at an institution	Account but no formal saving, million	Wages into an account	Saved for old age
All adults	100.0	36.8	59.4	70.5	43.1	22.1	37.0	20.2
Aged 15 to 24	18.2	31.1	66.2	72.2	38.6	4.9	36.9	8.2
Aged 25 and over	81.8	38.1	57.9	70.2	44.1	17.2	37.0	22.8
Secondary education or more	88.8	39.5	63.5	75.2	46.7	20.4	40.4	21.7
Richest 60%	60.0	46.0	72.0	85.5	53.8	15.3	49.5	26.5
In labour force	79.9	41.5	65.1	77.9	48.4	19.0	45.2	23.2
Poorest 40%	40.0	23.1	40.5	48.1	27.1	6.8	18.1	10.6

Source: World Bank (2025); authors' indices. Index A averages six indicators of formally held surplus (saving at an institution, monthly saving into an account, storing money in an account, receiving interest, saving for old age, covering two months without income). Index B averages six indicators of digital habit (digitally enabled account, daily internet use, smartphone, weekly card or mobile payment in store, checking a balance by phone, wages into an account). Segment population shares are recovered from the survey itself.

Table E2. Segment ranks under four weighting schemes

Segment	Equal weights	Value-heavy	Scale-heavy	Reach-heavy
Richest 60%	1	1	1	1
In labour force	2	2	2	2
Secondary education or more	3	4	3	3
Urban	4	3	5	4
Aged 25 and over	5	5	4	6
Aged 15 to 24	9	9	9	7

Source: authors' calculations from Table E1 and the full twelve-segment data. Each criterion is min-max normalised across the twelve segments. Weights on (Index A, Index B, gap, adults with an account but no saving, wage receipt, saving for old age) are 1, 1, 1, 1, 1 (equal);

3,1,1,1,2,2 (value-heavy); 1,1,1,3,1,1 (scale-heavy); and 1,3,2,1,1,1 (reach-heavy). With about 1,000 interviews, the 15-to-24 group rests on roughly 180 respondents, so small differences in rank sit within sampling error.

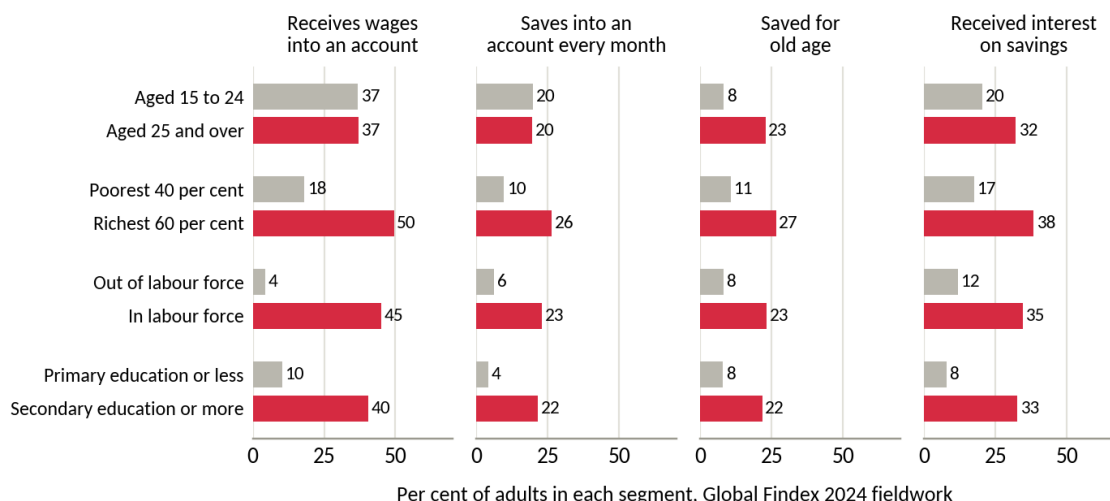


Figure E1. Payday and saving behaviour by segment pair
Source: World Bank (2025).

Table E3. Customer segments and objectives

Segment (E existing, N new)	Main barrier (hypothesis)	Objective
E1. Active and funded (85,739 active; 27,100 above VND 10 million)	Reliability; rivals' yields	Retain; add a goal
E2. Dormant intenders (about 1.4 million accounts below VND 10 million)	Procrastination; reward disputes	Launch target
N1. Salaried adults aged 22 to 40 (15 to 20 million account holders who do not save formally)	No route from salary to investment	Scale-up target
N2. First-time investors aged 15 to 24	Low capital; irregular income	Build habits cheaply
N3. Older, wealthy investors	Prefer human brokers and bank brands	Deprioritise

Source: Sections 2.2 and 2.7; World Bank (2025). Sizes and barriers are hypotheses for internal data to test. KPMG Vietnam (2025) expects 68.2 per cent of households to earn more than USD 5,000 a year by 2028.

Appendix F. Assumptions, sensitivity and alternative explanations

Table F1. Register of assumptions and derived measures

Item	Type	Effect if wrong	How Round 3 tests it
Segment sizes and barriers (Table E3)	Hypothesis	Wrong target or message	DNSE internal data; Findex microdata; survey
Share of dormant accounts held by intenders	Hypothesis	Enrolment falls short	Test 1 (survey and internal data)
Automation and trust features raise funding	Hypothesis supported by research abroad	Concept fails the pilot	Tests 2 to 4
Scenario inputs (savers, contribution, retention, fee yield)	Assumption	Outcomes change in proportion	Pilot read-out at month 6
Platform cost proxy	Derived proxy	Level may be over- or understated; trend reliable	DNSE management accounts
Cost of funds for DNSE and peers	Derived	Line 24 may include more provisions than assumed	Notes on borrowing terms
Account counts differ in date and definition	Measured, mixed dates	Per-account values shift by up to about 10 per cent	Internal account register
App reviews are self-selected	Measured, biased sample	Levels overstate dissatisfaction; comparisons across themes and apps are more reliable	Complaint logs; customer survey
Gen Z share of DNSE accounts	External estimate	Weaker or stronger mismatch	DNSE demographic data
Regulatory feasibility	Assumption	Launch delayed	Test 5 (compliance review and SSC notice)

Source: authors.

Table F2. Alternative explanations tested

Explanation	Evidence	Verdict
The market cycle explains low balances	Assets per account fell 9.5% in 2025 while the VN-Index rose 41%; the 2026 cash outflow hit all brokers in similar proportion	Rejected
DNSE lacks capital to lend	Loans were 116% of equity against a 200% ceiling, leaving room for about VND 4.6 trillion more	Rejected
Every broker counts dormant accounts	Peers with similar account counts lend 5 to 12 times more per account	Rejected
Reliability alone deters funding	Reliability complaints are as common at VPS, which lends five times more per account	Partly rejected
DNSE acquires young customers now to earn from them later	Public data do not separate cohorts by year of account opening	Cannot be rejected; needs cohort data

Source: Sections 2 and 3; Appendix C.

Table F3. Never-Sleeping Account and Payday Portfolio

	Never-Sleeping Account	Payday Portfolio
Job	Earns a return on cash already deposited	Brings new money in and invests it regularly
Customers	Active traders with idle cash (E1)	Salaried intenders who have not funded (E2, N1)
Trigger	Customer decides to deposit	Payday, automatically
Return	1.8% base plus bonuses for large balances and trading value	Chosen bonds, funds and exchange-traded funds
Behavioural mechanism	None	Default, automation and goal tracking

Source: DNSE Securities (2026b); authors' design.

Table F4. Customer concerns, design responses and published proof

Customer concern (from reviews)	Design response	Published proof
Money cannot be withdrawn	Cash back to the linked bank 24/7; no closure fee	Median withdrawal time
Customers are locked in	Pause, skip or cancel in one tap, free of charge	Cancellations completed in the app
Conditions are hidden	All terms on one screen; rewards only on money that stays	Trust themes below 10% of negative reviews (37% since 2025)
Customers cannot see where money sits	Screen showing the segregated client account and securities held in the customer's name	Monthly statement
The app crashes	Transfers run as scheduled back-end jobs; reliability is a launch gate	Transfer success of 99.5% or more
The product may not be legal	Product notified to the SSC before launch	Written confirmation

Source: Appendix D; authors' design.

Table F5. Outcomes 18 months after launch (all inputs are assumptions)

	Conservative	Base	Upside
Savers enrolled	60,000	150,000	300,000
Monthly contribution, VND million	1.0	1.5	2.5
Share of contributions kept	60%	70%	80%
Assets, VND trillion (multiple of investor cash)	0.65 (0.3)	2.84 (1.4)	10.80 (5.5)
Annual fees, VND billion	3	23	108
Tier interest, upper bound, VND billion a year	1.5	5.6	18.8
Accounts with VND 10 million or more (share of mid-2026 base)	87,100 (5.1%)	177,100 (10.4%)	327,100 (19.2%)

Source: authors' projections (Appendix F1; Figure F1).

F1. Scenario method for Table F5. Assets per saver equal the monthly contribution times the share kept times 18 months, before investment returns (VND 10.8, 18.9 and 36.0 million). Payday Portfolio assets equal assets per saver times the number of savers. Annual fees apply a yield of 0.5, 0.8 and 1.0 per cent to assets, covering bond and fund distribution. The count of accounts holding VND 10 million or more adds

the savers to the 27,100 accounts already above that level, assuming that savers start below VND 10 million and pass it within 18 months. The average conservative-case saver only just passes it, so that count is an upper bound. Shares divide by the mid-2026 base of 1.7 million accounts, so new sign-ups do not dilute them. The base case needs about one account in eleven to enrol, 1.75 times the customers active in December 2025. Costs of incentives, marketing and technology are estimated in Round 3 (test 7). The upper bound on tier interest assumes that every saver keeps one full month's contribution in the idle-cash account at 2.5 points above the base rate, the gap between 1.8 and 4.3 per cent. The comparison with sign-up rewards multiplies VND 100,000 by the 518,514 accounts opened in 2025. The investor-cash comparison in Section 3.2 divides industry investor cash of VND 86.6 trillion by 13.85 million accounts, which gives VND 6.25 million per account, against VND 1.15 million at DNSE.

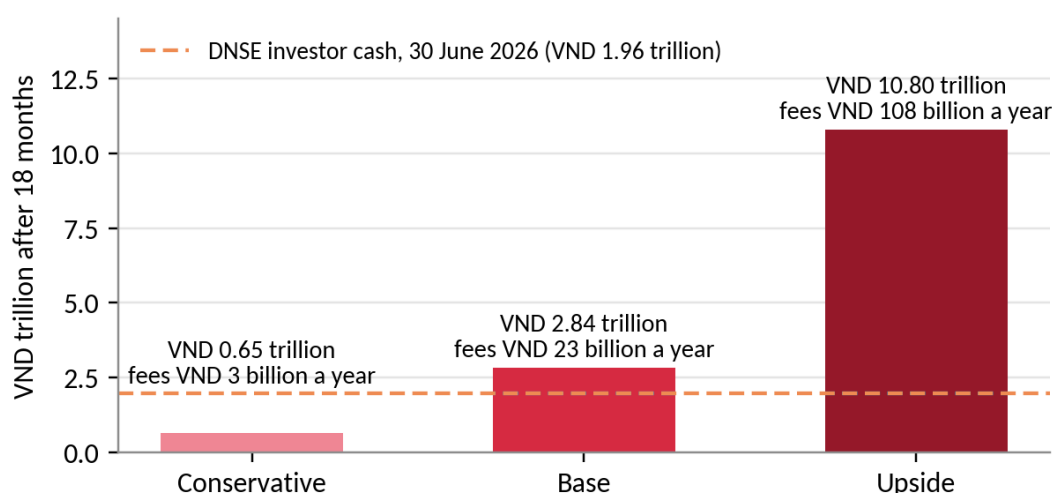


Figure F1. Payday Portfolio assets after 18 months under three scenarios

Source: Table F5.

F2. Validation direction. The headline KPI is the number of accounts holding VND 10 million or more, which DNSE already reports. It was 27,100 (1.8 per cent of accounts) at the end of 2025, and the target is 85,000 within 18 months, 5 per cent of the mid-2026 base. Supporting KPIs are the share of savers reaching three and six consecutive contributions, net new money, cost per funded account (VND 7.3 million today) and the trust share of negative reviews (37 per cent since 2025). Table F6 ranks the assumptions by the damage they would cause if wrong. DNSE should scale only if tests 1 to 4 pass and both gates hold. If enrolment falls short while retention holds, the message changes, and if retention fails, the concept stops (Figure F2).

Table F6. Priority assumptions, tests and thresholds for Round 3

#	Assumption	Test	Threshold to proceed
1	Many dormant accounts belong to salaried intenders	Internal data; survey of 2,000 customers	30% or more intend to invest
2	Advised automation turns intention into funding	Randomised pilot with 20,000 customers	15% enrol in 60 days; 70% of money kept at day 90
3	Tiers and the skip month raise persistence	Pilot arms with and without tiers	Six-contribution rate up 10 points
4	Trust features raise set-up	A/B test of the trust screen	Set-up completion up 5 points
5	The advice flow is compliant (gate)	Compliance review; SSC notice	Written confirmation
6	Transfers are reliable (gate)	Load tests; shadow payday runs	99.5% transfer success
7	Inflows are new money; unit costs fall	Tag inflow sources; track costs	80% new money; cost below VND 7.3 million per funded account

Source: authors' design.

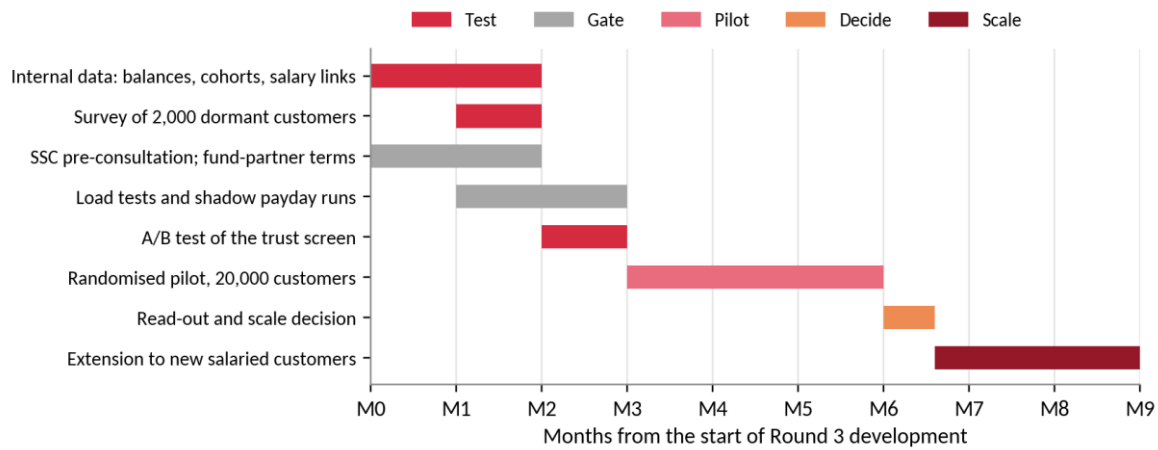


Figure F2. Validation roadmap for Round 3

Source: authors' design.

Appendix G. Regulatory basis and technology proposals

Table G1 records how each proposal was tested against the licensing and lending rules that apply to a securities company. The decisions define the scope of the first release in Section 4.

Table G1. Assessment of the proposed features and technology add-ons

Proposal	What it would do	Main constraint	Decision
Ensa suitability check and model portfolios	Records goal, horizon, income and risk tolerance; proposes one of three model portfolios	This is investment advice; Circular 121/2020, Article 24 requires this client information	Adopt inside DNSE's advisory licence; the customer confirms
Automatic rebalancing	Sells and buys to restore target weights	Article 4 bars investing on a client's behalf without a mandate; each sale incurs 0.1% tax	Adopt with new money only; changes confirmed in one tap
Paid membership tier	Monthly fee for extra features	Fees before any return repeat the terms that customers call deceptive	Replace with free tiers earned by contributions
ZaloPay round-up micro-investing	Rounds up wallet payments and invests the difference	Small amounts; needs ZaloPay's product work; funding of cashback unclear	Phase-2 test for young users
Ensa Smart Vaults via Lightspeed API	Algorithmic portfolios executed automatically for an asset-based fee	Portfolio management is outside a securities company's four licensed businesses (Law on Securities, Article 72); speed adds little for monthly savers	Set aside; possible later as funds from a licensed manager that DNSE distributes
Margin-on-Wealth credit line	Overdraft secured on Golden Egg, fund units and idle cash	Article 27 limits lending to margin and defined purposes; fund units are not listed securities; 2026 fine on unreported advance services	Reject
Margin Deal discount as a tier reward	Cheaper leverage after twelve contributions	Conflicts with a saver's goal and with the 2026 inspection findings	Exclude from rewards
Transparency dashboard and VNeID checks	Shows the segregated client account; faster identity checks	Needs a bank data feed; VNeID integration to be confirmed	Adopt the dashboard; test VNeID

Source: Ministry of Finance (2020); National Assembly (2019); Market Times (2026); DNSE Securities (2026d); authors' assessment.

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